Affinity Diagram

APSS main site redesign and new research site · what we heard, grouped

ENSE 271 · Group B · Activity 1
Group B
October 2026

Method (Nielsen Norman Group): 1 One finding per note, from five sources 2 Notes grouped bottom-up by similarity, each group named in the user's voice 3 One takeaway per group, groups numbered by priority

Client: Erin's empathy map · Client brief · Team notes · Site review: APSS site, reportneedles.ca · Published research · Open question

36 notes · 7 groups · 4 open questions

FAST ACCESS TO SERVICES

"I need help right now" 1

- Easy access to Needle Exchange and Support — TEAM NOTES
- Icons that go somewhere; quick movement through the page — TEAM NOTES
- Pain: "hot link icons" — ERIN
- Services are buried in a menu of about 30 links — SITE REVIEW
- No site search on the main site — SITE REVIEW
- Runs needle exchange, naloxone and support services — ERIN

So: Put the most-used services one tap from both homepages.

FINDABILITY

"I can't find the research" 2

- Research is hidden under About Us: one short page, 3 links — SITE REVIEW
- No list of papers, posters or updates anywhere — SITE REVIEW
- We need a searchable research database — TEAM NOTES
- Visitors should browse current and completed projects — BRIEF
- Thinks: "general publication", "community report" — ERIN

So: Give research its own home, with a library you can search and filter by type, year and project.

MOVING BETWEEN SITES

"How do I get back?" 3

- Move easily between research site, main site and reportneedles.ca — BRIEF
- reportneedles.ca has no research links or credits — SITE REVIEW
- Main site isn't WordPress, so we can only link to it — SITE REVIEW
- Unsure: "separate website? single page?" — ERIN
- reportneedles.ca takes location, type, photo, landmark — ERIN

So: Put the same links to APSS and reportneedles.ca in the same place on every page of both sites.

STIGMA AND PRIVACY

"Don't judge me, don't track me" 4

- Feels stigma around drug use, STI, HIV and Hep C — ERIN
- Pain: stigma around drug use — ERIN
- Needle reports can be fully anonymous — SITE REVIEW
- reportneedles.ca analytics don't track personal data — SITE REVIEW

So: Never require a name to get help, and use real, respectful photos.

CREDIBILITY

"Show me it's real research" 5

- Present research "clearly and professionally" — BRIEF
- Wants it similar to the Eaton Lab's website — ERIN
- Thinks: "research focused" — ERIN
- 3 journal papers: 2024, 2025, 2026 — RESEARCH
- 3 posters and 3 talks at CAHR 2026 — RESEARCH

So: Show authors, journal, funders and date on every item.

VISUAL DESIGN AND ACCESSIBILITY

"Make it clear and readable" 6

- Replace the AI art — TEAM NOTES
- Banner text is baked into an AI image; screen readers can't read it — SITE REVIEW
- Carousels autoplay and keep moving after you interact — SITE REVIEW
- Broken Twitter link; phone number doesn't dial — SITE REVIEW
- Thinks: "engaging" — ERIN

So: Real photos, real text, and nothing that moves on its own.

IMPACT AND SUPPORT

"Why should I care, or give?" 7

- "Sask was top in HIV cases due to needles" — ERIN
- 34,350 needles collected from 466 reports since 2021 — RESEARCH
- Pain: needs government support — ERIN
- Funded by SHRF, CIHR and CTN+ — RESEARCH
- Public wants to donate, support and learn the history — TEAM NOTES
- Gain: help people with needs and diseases — ERIN

So: Lead with impact numbers; they speak to donors, funders and the public.

STILL UNKNOWN

Ask Erin on Oct 7

- Separate research site, or one research page? — OPEN QUESTION
- Host the PDFs, or link to the journals? — OPEN QUESTION
- Who updates the sites after December? — OPEN QUESTION
- What did "hot link icons" mean? — OPEN QUESTION

So: Her answers go in the customer notes and may move notes between groups.